absolute value of x to x itself, the code above can be simplified as:

```
if x < 0 then
  x ← -x
```

## A.3.1 Else-if

Other times we need to decide between more than two branches. In that case, while it is possible to implement the same logic using multiple nested `if-then-else` statements, it would make the code cumbersome and mangled (because of the indentation).

A more succinct approach uses the else-if variant, common in script languages like Python and Ruby.

Here we decided to use the `elsif` keyword:

```
if x < 0 then
  y ← -1/x
elsif x > 0 then
  y ← 1/x
else
  y ← NaN
```

Incidentally, the listing above computes the absolute value of the reciprocal of a number x, and `NaN` stands for “not a number”, that’s the best choice to express the fact that 1/0 is not defined[2].